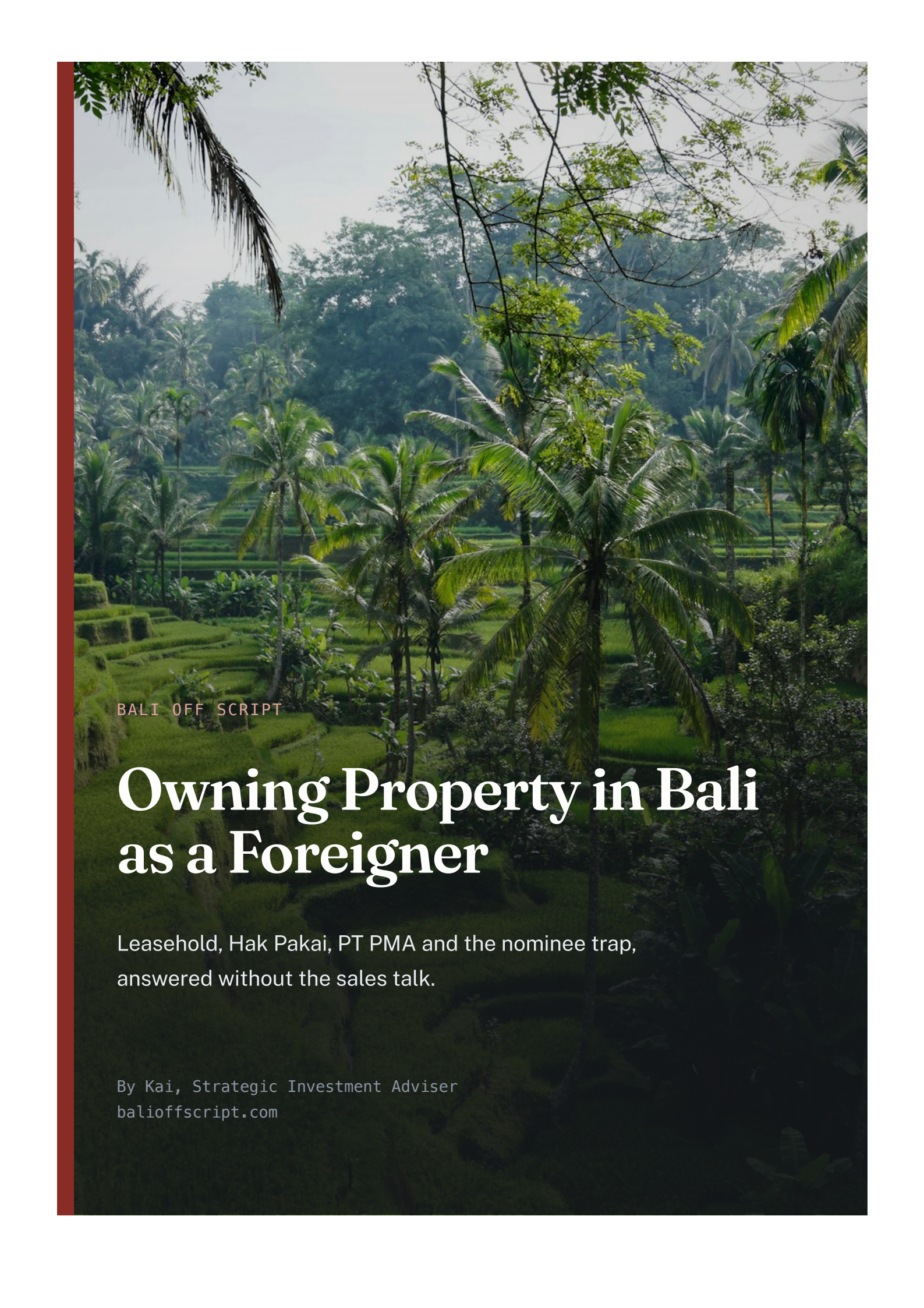




BALI OFF SCRIPT

Owning Property in Bali as a Foreigner

Leasehold, Hak Pakai, PT PMA and the nominee trap,
answered without the sales talk.

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How to use this guide. Every question buyers ask me about this topic, each with the short answer. The link under each one opens the full answer with the sources. Rules change: check the date on the page, and verify anything before you sign with your own notary, lawyer and tax consultant.

Ownership

What foreigners can actually own, and how the three legal routes really work.

Can a foreigner own property in Bali?

Not freehold. But three legal structures exist, and one of them puts a certificate in your own name.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/can-foreigners-own-property-in-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/can-foreigners-own-property-in-bali/)

Leasehold or freehold in Bali?

Foreigners cannot hold freehold at all, so the real comparison is between leasehold, Hak Pakai and a company holding HGB. Here is how the three actually differ.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/leasehold-vs-freehold-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/leasehold-vs-freehold-bali/)

What are the property laws in Bali?

One national framework, one regional layer, and six rules that decide everything a foreign buyer can and cannot do.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-law/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-law/)

What is the difference between SHM, SHGB and Hak Pakai?

Four land rights, four different answers to who can hold them and for how long. Getting this wrong is how people end up with nothing.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/shm-shgb-shp-certificate-types/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/shm-shgb-shp-certificate-types/)

What makes a Bali leasehold extension clause actually safe?

The initial term is not the asset. The extension clause is, and most of them are worthless.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/leasehold-extension-clause/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/leasehold-extension-clause/)

Guaranteed or priority extension in a Bali lease?

Two Indonesian phrases that look interchangeable in a lease. One gives you an extension. The other gives you the right to ask.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/jaminan-vs-prioritas-perpanjangan/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/jaminan-vs-prioritas-perpanjangan/)

HGB or leasehold: which is actually better?

One is a registered right you can mortgage. The other is a contract that expires. The right answer depends on what you intend to do with it.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/hgb-vs-leasehold-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/hgb-vs-leasehold-bali/)

What actually happens if you buy through a nominee?

The agreement is void the day it is signed, and since February 2026 it is criminal in Bali.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/nominee-structure-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/nominee-structure-bali/)

How does Hak Pakai work, and who can actually get it?

The one route that registers land in a foreigner's own name. Requires residency, and most people are never told it exists.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-pakai-explained/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-pakai-explained/)

Is a Bali leasehold registered anywhere?

Hak Sewa appears on no certificate and in no government register. Your entire protection is the notarised deed, which changes how you verify everything.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-sewa-not-registered/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-sewa-not-registered/)

What are the actual steps to buy property in Bali?

Five stages, and the money should not move until the second one. Where the deposit sits decides whether you get it back.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-process-bali-step-by-step/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-process-bali-step-by-step/)

Can a Bali lease run 80 years?

Indonesian practice allows leasehold arrangements reaching about 80 years, but almost no notary will write it as one term. Here is how it is actually built.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-lease-80-years/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-lease-80-years/)

What happens when your Indonesian land right expires?

Every land right in Indonesia is temporary except freehold. On expiry it reverts, and renewal is approval, not entitlement.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/land-rights-expiry-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/land-rights-expiry-bali/)

How does a foreigner actually buy land in Bali?

The full sequence, in the order it has to happen, and where the money should be at each step.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-land-bali-foreigner/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-land-bali-foreigner/)

Who owns the villa you built on leased land?

Land and building are separable in Indonesian law. Whether your villa reverts with the land at expiry depends entirely on a clause most leases leave silent.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/who-owns-the-building-bali-lease/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/who-owns-the-building-bali-lease/)

Can you sell or transfer a Bali leasehold?

Your exit depends on a clause most buyers never read. If assignment needs the landowner's consent and that consent has a price, you do not fully control your own sale.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/transferring-bali-lease/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/transferring-bali-lease/)

How safe is your money in a Bali property deal?

Safer than the horror stories suggest, and only if you do four specific things.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/how-safe-is-your-money-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/how-safe-is-your-money-bali/)

Do you need a prenup to own property in a mixed marriage?

Without one, a foreign spouse's interest can contaminate an Indonesian spouse's freehold. This is the most consequential document in a mixed marriage here.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/prenuptial-agreement-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/prenuptial-agreement-indonesia/)

What happens to your Bali property when you die?

A home country will does not settle an Indonesian land title, and heirs who cannot lawfully hold it face a disposal deadline.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/wills-inheritance-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/wills-inheritance-indonesia/)

How do you sell a property in Bali?

Exit is the part nobody plans. Your buyer pool, your remaining lease term and your licence position decide the price far more than the villa does.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/selling-property-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/selling-property-bali/)

What are the common property scams in Bali?

The losses here follow a small number of repeating patterns, and almost all of them happen before the deed is ever signed.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-scams/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-scams/)

What does a notary do in a Bali property purchase?

The PPAT executes the deed and registers the transfer. Using the seller's notary is the cheapest way to lose your only independent check.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/notary-ppat-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/notary-ppat-bali/)

What should you ask a Bali property agent?

Most agents will answer what you ask and not much more. These are the questions that surface the problems before you pay a deposit.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/questions-to-ask-bali-agent/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/questions-to-ask-bali-agent/)

Can you get a mortgage in Bali?

Foreign buyers here are effectively cash buyers. Local lending is largely closed and the alternatives carry their own problems.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/financing-property-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/financing-property-bali/)

What are the hidden costs of buying in Bali?

Budget the purchase price and nothing else and you are roughly 7 percent short before you have furnished anything.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-hidden-costs-buying/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-hidden-costs-buying/)

How does a power of attorney work in Indonesia?

Useful for transacting from abroad, and routinely misused as the paperwork propping up an unlawful nominee arrangement.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/power-of-attorney-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/power-of-attorney-indonesia/)

What happens if a Bali property deal goes wrong?

Litigation here is slow, expensive and uncertain for foreigners. Almost everything worth doing about a dispute happens before you sign.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-disputes/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-disputes/)

Can you own a beach in Indonesia?

Nobody owns the beach. Understanding what those beachfront businesses actually hold explains a lot about what beachfront land is worth.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/beach-ownership-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/beach-ownership-indonesia/)

How does leasehold work in Bali?

The instrument most foreign buyers here actually hold. It is a contract, not a title, and that distinction decides what happens when things go wrong.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-sewa-leasehold-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/hak-sewa-leasehold-bali/)

What do all the Bali property terms mean?

Every Indonesian term a foreign buyer will meet, in plain English, with what it actually means for you.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-glossary/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-glossary/)

How do you pay for a property in Bali?

Bank transfer, in your own name, to the registered owner, against written conditions. Every alternative exists to make somebody else's life easier.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/paying-for-bali-property/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/paying-for-bali-property/)

How long does due diligence take in Bali?

A clean title takes one to three weeks to verify properly. Anyone pressuring you inside that window is telling you something about the deal.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-due-diligence-timeline/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-due-diligence-timeline/)

How do you convert a land title in Indonesia?

Moving land from a citizen's freehold to a right a foreigner or a company can hold is a normal procedure, and the gap between agreeing it and completing it is where money gets stuck.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/converting-title-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/converting-title-indonesia/)

What is splittable land in Bali?

Whether a parcel can be legally divided decides your exit options, your financing and often the price. Most buyers never ask.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/splittable-land-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/splittable-land-bali/)

What documents do you need to buy property in Bali?

The list is short, and the ones that matter most are the documents the seller has to produce, not the ones you do.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/documents-to-buy-property-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/documents-to-buy-property-bali/)

Should you list a Bali villa exclusively or with every agent?

Open listings feel safer and usually sell for less. The reason is what an agent will and will not spend money on.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/exclusive-vs-open-listing-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/exclusive-vs-open-listing-bali/)

How do you prepare a Bali villa for sale?

The paperwork takes longer than the presentation and matters more. Start it three months before you list.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/preparing-villa-for-sale-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/preparing-villa-for-sale-bali/)

How do you buy Bali property with a partner?

Two people, one lease, and no registered title to record who owns what. The agreement between you is the only thing that decides it.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-property-with-a-partner-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-property-with-a-partner-bali/)

How do joint ventures with Bali landowners work?

The landowner contributes land, you contribute capital, and you split the return. It works when the documents are right and fails completely when they are not.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/joint-venture-landowner-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/joint-venture-landowner-bali/)

What is girik land in Bali?

Girik is not a certificate. It is evidence of possession on unregistered land, and it trades at a discount that reflects real risk.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/girik-land-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/girik-land-bali/)

What is the risk of buying inherited land in Bali?

Land that passed down a family without being formally divided has more than one owner, and the seller may be only one of them.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/inherited-land-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/inherited-land-bali/)

How do you check access rights to Bali land?

A road you drove down to view the land may belong to a neighbour. If your access is not documented, it can close.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/access-rights-right-of-way-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/access-rights-right-of-way-bali/)

Do you need a land survey in Bali?

The advertised area, the certificate area and what is physically fenced are frequently three different numbers. A survey is how you find out.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/boundary-survey-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/boundary-survey-bali/)

How do off-market property deals work in Bali?

The best parcels frequently never reach a listing. Getting access means relationships, and it also means fewer checks have been done for you.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/off-market-property-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/off-market-property-bali/)

Can you buy a Bali villa with a tenant in it?

Existing agreements bind you. A tenancy, a management contract or forward bookings all transfer with the property whether you wanted them or not.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-villa-with-tenant-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-villa-with-tenant-bali/)

What should a villa inspection cover in Bali?

A walkthrough at midday tells you almost nothing. The things that cost money are structural, hidden and visible only if you look for them.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/villa-inspection-checklist-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/villa-inspection-checklist-bali/)

What happens when a Bali lease expires?

The building passes with the land, your right to be there ends, and whatever you did not negotiate decades earlier is what you get.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/what-happens-when-lease-expires-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/what-happens-when-lease-expires-bali/)

Should you buy land or a finished villa in Bali?

Building saves fifteen to twenty-five percent and starts with a full term. It costs you eighteen months, real attention and permit risk.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-land-vs-villa-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-land-vs-villa-bali/)

What are the warning signs on a Bali property?

Most losses here are preceded by the same handful of signals. None of them are subtle once you know what they are.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-red-flags/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/bali-property-red-flags/)

What documents should a Bali property owner keep?

There is no register behind a leasehold. The file you keep is the evidence, and an heir who cannot find it has a genuine problem.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/property-record-keeping-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/property-record-keeping-bali/)

Can you buy Bali property without visiting?

It is possible and it removes the checks that matter most. If you must do it, this is the structure that makes it survivable.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-bali-property-remotely/](https://balioffscript.com/ownership/buying-bali-property-remotely/)

Companies

PT PMA setup, capital rules, licensing and the annual compliance load.

How much capital do you need for a PT PMA in 2026?

The paid-up requirement dropped 75% in October 2025. The investment plan requirement did not.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-capital-2026/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-capital-2026/)

What does a PT PMA actually cost to keep running each year?

Setup gets quoted. The annual load rarely does, and it is where these structures quietly fail.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-annual-compliance/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-annual-compliance/)

Can a PT PMA still get a villa rental licence in Bali?

No. Bali closed the villa and homestay classifications to new foreign-owned companies in July 2026. Two routes remain open.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-kbli-closure-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-kbli-closure-bali/)

How long does it really take to set up a PT PMA?

Six to ten weeks to a trading licence if nothing stalls. Here is the phase-by-phase reality, and what usually goes wrong.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-setup-timeline/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-setup-timeline/)

How do you hire staff in a PT PMA?

Base salaries are low and the obligations around them are not. Termination in particular is far harder and more expensive than foreign owners expect.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-hiring-staff/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-hiring-staff/)

What is an NIB and how does OSS work?

The NIB is your business identity number and OSS is the system that issues it. Getting the classification right is the whole job.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/oss-nib-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/oss-nib-indonesia/)

How do you close a PT PMA?

A dormant company does not quietly disappear. Obligations keep accruing and the eventual cost of regularising exceeds maintaining it.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/closing-a-pt-pma/](https://balioffscript.com/company/closing-a-pt-pma/)

How do you open a company bank account in Indonesia?

The step that stalls more company formations than any other, and the one you cannot do remotely.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/corporate-bank-account-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/corporate-bank-account-indonesia/)

What accounting does a PT PMA need?

Monthly filings, quarterly reports and annual statements, owed whether or not the company earned anything.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-accounting-tax/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-accounting-tax/)

Can a foreigner be a director of an Indonesian company?

Holding shares is not the same as being allowed to work. Directors without the right authorisation are exposed, and enforcement has tightened.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/work-permit-foreign-director/](https://balioffscript.com/company/work-permit-foreign-director/)

Can a PT PMA use a virtual office?

Cheap and widely used for company formation, and the point where banks and licensing sometimes say no.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/virtual-office-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/virtual-office-indonesia/)

What is a representative office in Indonesia?

A foreign company can have a legal presence here without forming a PT PMA. It cannot earn revenue, which is the entire trade-off.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/representative-office-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/representative-office-indonesia/)

What is a yayasan and can a foreigner run one?

The non-profit vehicle behind most schools, clinics and NGOs here. It cannot distribute profit, and using one to hold a business is a known trap.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/yayasan-foundation-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/yayasan-foundation-indonesia/)

PT PMA or Hak Pakai for a Bali property?

One is a personal right that needs residency. The other is a company that needs a business. Choosing on cost alone is how people end up with the wrong one.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-vs-hak-pakai/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-vs-hak-pakai/)

What is a RUPS and does your PT PMA need one?

An Indonesian company law requirement that single-shareholder companies routinely forget, and that surfaces when you try to sell or restructure.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/rups-shareholder-meeting-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/rups-shareholder-meeting-indonesia/)

What is a PMDN and can a foreigner use one?

A PMDN is a domestic investment company with no foreign shareholding. Using one to hold property for a foreigner is a nominee arrangement.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pmdn-domestic-investment-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pmdn-domestic-investment-indonesia/)

Does a PT PMA need an audit?

Above defined thresholds an audit is mandatory. Below them the accounts still have to exist, and a buyer's lawyer will read them.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-audit-requirements/](https://balioffscript.com/company/pt-pma-audit-requirements/)

Does a PT PMA need a company secretary?

The filings people remember are the tax ones. The company law obligations are the ones that surface when you try to sell.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/company/corporate-secretary-indonesia/](https://balioffscript.com/company/corporate-secretary-indonesia/)

Want a second pair of eyes?

I look at deals before people sign: the documents, the zoning, the lease and the numbers.
Message me with what you are looking at.

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